

1. Definition of Forward Chaining

Forward chaining is a **data-driven inference method** used in Artificial Intelligence.

It:

- Starts from known facts
- Applies logical rules
- Derives new facts
- Continues until no new facts can be generated or goal is reached

It is commonly used in:

- Expert systems
- Rule-based AI systems
- Knowledge-based systems

2. Simple Example Problem

Knowledge Base (Rules):

R1: $A \rightarrow B$

R2: $B \rightarrow C$

R3: $C \rightarrow D$

Initial Fact:

A is True

Expected Output:

D should become True after forward chaining.

3. Python Code for Forward Chaining

```
# Simple Forward Chaining Implementation

# Step 1: Define initial facts
facts = {"A"}    # A is initially true

# Step 2: Define rules as (premise, conclusion)
rules = [
    ("A", "B"),
    ("B", "C"),
    ("C", "D")
]

# Step 3: Forward Chaining Algorithm
changed = True

while changed:
    changed = False
    for premise, conclusion in rules:
        # If premise is true and conclusion not already known
        if premise in facts and conclusion not in facts:
            print(f"Rule applied: {premise} → {conclusion}")
            facts.add(conclusion)
            changed = True

# Step 4: Final Facts
print("\nFinal facts derived:")
print(facts)
```

4. Explanation of the Code

1. We store known facts in a set:
facts = {"A"}
2. Rules are stored as tuples:
("A", "B") means $A \rightarrow B$
3. The algorithm:
 - Loops through rules
 - If premise is in facts
 - Adds conclusion to facts
 - Repeats until no new facts are added
4. Output will be:

Rule applied: $A \rightarrow B$

Rule applied: $B \rightarrow C$

Rule applied: $C \rightarrow D$

Final facts derived:

{'A', 'B', 'C', 'D'}

5. How This Demonstrates Forward Chaining

Step-by-step reasoning:

A is true

→ B becomes true

→ C becomes true

→ D becomes true

The system moves forward from facts to conclusions.

6. Classroom Enhancement Idea (For Your AI Students)

You can modify the example:

Rules:

Fever $\wedge$ Cough $\rightarrow$ Flu

Flu $\rightarrow$ Rest

Extend code to support multiple conditions in premise.